

Northwind Engineering — New Hire Onboarding

Getting access

New engineers request access through the IT portal. Standard access includes GitHub (the northwind-inc org), the AWS developer account, PagerDuty, and Slack. Production database access requires a separate request approved by your team lead and is granted for 90 days at a time.

Local setup

Clone the northwind-inc/platform monorepo. Install Node.js 20 and Docker. Run 'make bootstrap' to start local Postgres, Redis, and Kafka via docker-compose. Copy .env.sample to .env and fill in your personal API keys. Run 'make test' to verify the setup.

Team structure

Engineering has four teams. The Platform team owns infrastructure and CI/CD. The Payments team owns the Payments Service and billing. The Orders team owns the Orders and Inventory services. The Growth team owns the Notifications Service and customer-facing features. The VP of Engineering is Priya Nair.

First week

In your first week you should complete the security training, ship one small change to production, and pair with a teammate on an on-call shadow. Your onboarding buddy is assigned on day one. Ask questions in the #eng-help Slack channel.